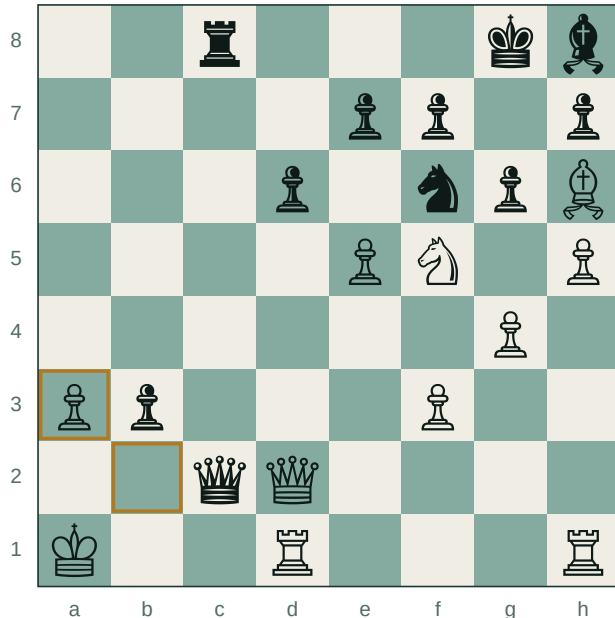


Double checks: Black, move 26

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 26.bxa3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...b2+ 27. Ka2 b1=Q#

26...b2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **27.Ka2**.

27...b1=Q# Mate: queen on b1 and queen on c2 give check; White has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b1 and queen on c2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on a1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.